

The Party Crashers

An ESL lesson on slang, invitations, and awkward situations

Vocabulary Spotlight

1

invitation

A written or spoken request asking someone to come somewhere.

"We got an invitation to my cousin's wedding."

2

crash a party

To go to a party or social event without an invitation.

"Some strangers crashed our New Year's party."

3

tag along

To go somewhere with someone, often when you aren't the main guest.

"Can I tag along when you go to the mall?"

4

blend in

To look or act like the people around you so you don't stand out.

"I wore a suit to blend in at the meeting."

5

awkward

Feeling uncomfortable, self-conscious, or embarrassed.

"It was awkward when I forgot my boss's name."

Say It Naturally

Native speakers link a final consonant to the next vowel, so the words run together. Capital letters show the stressed syllable. Say each one three times.

invitation
in-vi-TAY-shun

crash a party
CRA-sha PAR-ty

tag along
ta-ga-LONG

blend in
blen-DIN

awkward
AWK-werd



Ms. Gabriela and Ms. Staycee at the party. What do you think they are saying?

Fill-in-the-Blank Dialogue

Setting: Ms. Gabriela and Ms. Staycee are standing near the snack table at a lively party. They are whispering.



Ms. Gabriela: Staycee, look around. Everyone here looks like a lawyer. Are you absolutely sure we have an _____ (1) to this event?

Ms. Staycee: Honestly, Gabriela? No. Another teacher told me about it, and I decided to just _____ (2).

Ms. Gabriela: Oh my gosh, Staycee! You mean we just _____ (3) this party? We don't even know the host!

Ms. Staycee: Relax! Grab a plate of food, look confident, and try to _____ (4) with the crowd. No one is checking names at the door.

Ms. Gabriela: I don't know... If the host realizes we are ESL teachers and asks who we know, it's going to be so _____ (5). I'm terrible at making up stories!

Ms. Staycee: If anyone asks, just say we are friends of a guy named Dave. Trust me, there is always a Dave at a party.



invitation



crash



tag along



awkward

Word Bank

awkward

blend in

crashed

invitation

tag along

Check Your Understanding

1. Did Ms. Gabriela and Ms. Staycee get an invitation to the party?

2. How did Ms. Staycee find out about the party?

3. Why is Ms. Gabriela worried?

Your Turn: The Host Walks Over

The host smiles and asks, "Hi! How do you know everyone?" With a partner, act it out. **Partner A** is the host. **Partner B** is one of the party crashers. Then switch.

"Actually, I came with ____."

"I'm a friend of ____."

"I'm so sorry, I didn't realize ____."

"Would it be okay if we ____?"

Answer Key

1. invitation
2. tag along
3. crashed
4. blend in
5. awkward

Check Your Understanding

1. No. They don't have an invitation; they crashed the party.
2. Another teacher told her about it.
3. She's afraid the host will ask who they know, and she's terrible at making up stories.